

Checks, captures, and threats form a scan

Thinking And Training

THE IDEA

Forcing moves narrow the opponent's choices, so they are useful starting points for calculation. Scan checks, captures, and direct threats for both sides. They are candidates rather than commands; many checks are harmless or losing.

WORKED EXAMPLE

A check that drives the enemy king to safety may help the defender. A quiet move threatening mate can be stronger if it also stops the opponent's counterplay. Compare consequences after the defender's best answer.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

Why scan the opponent's checks before beginning your own attack?

ANSWER AND REASONING

A checking reply can interrupt your intended sequence and win material or force mate. Your attack only works if the opponent cannot use a stronger forcing resource first.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Prioritize forcing moves, then judge their outcomes.